

almost all the domains of semiconductor manufacturing including design, production, sales, and marketing, he does not call himself a product definition guy. His expertise, as he points out, lies in designing chips in accordance with specifications available. “How do you design a chip, how do you move the fab, and how do you package is my expertise. As far as the sales and marketing go, I have run two startup companies in the past and running a listed company now, so I have got fairly good skills and knowledge of how sales and marketing works,” he says.

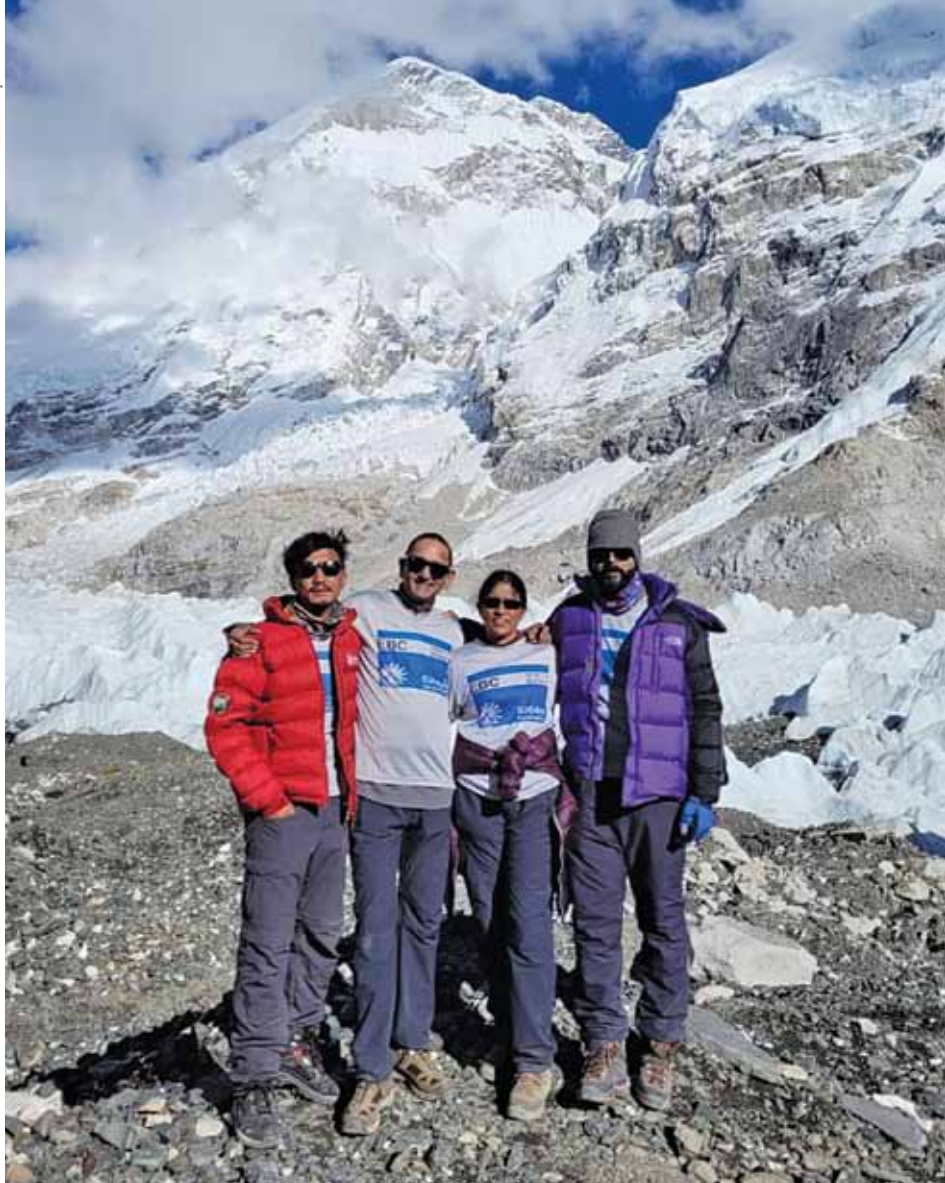
Venkata went to pursue PhD and then quit in between, packed bags and moved to Silicon Valley. The decision was partially influenced by his peers who had completed their masters and were working in Silicon valley for some of the top semiconductor companies. “I was highly inspired by the quality of work these people were doing in Silicon Valley. A lot of my seniors were working for Intel and other big names. The work and life in Silicon Valley excited me more than the PhD I was pursuing. I took the decision to move to Silicon Valley and be part of the action,” he says.

“I never felt that I made the wrong decision. What I am today is because of that one decision I bravely took. My wife backed me up and the journey from there has been an excellent one,” says Venkata. Today, Venkata works with engineers with PhD degree and has tremendous respect for the expertise and knowledge they bring to the table.

The chip-design couple

This might come as a surprise to many, but Venkata’s better half is a chip-design engineer as well. While a lot of us might think, keeping the couple’s profession in consideration, that it was a love marriage, it actually was an arranged one. “After her bachelors in Electronics, she enrolled in masters in the same school where I was doing my PhD. She graduated in computer science but after moving to Silicon valley, she saw opportunities in chip design and slowly transitioned towards the chip design side,” says a happy Venkata.

Another striking similarity



Venkata with his sons Vishwajit and Satyajit, and wife Srilaxmi

between the two is the love and respect they share for sports. While Venkata, as mentioned earlier, is someone who loves playing table tennis, Mrs Simhadri played volleyball and badminton during her school days.

And what’s the most romantic thing that Venkata has done for Mrs. Simhadri? The couple went to a Half Dome hike in Yosemite, California together! The hike, for the record, takes ten to twelve hours for experienced hikers. The couple, regulars to activities like hiking, completed the journey in company of each other, and that, as Venkata’s eyes fill with romance, is the most romantic thing.

“It is a pretty challenging hike. We motivated each other before and during the hike. I helped her climb the most difficult part of the hike, and we

both reached the top together. Anything you do and achieve together is the best feeling in the world,” he says with a wide smile. He adds, “It made my day when she told me I could not have done it without you.”

The couple has two sons—Vishwajit and Satyajit, both of whom have completed computer engineering. Like parents, they are regular in sports too and enjoy the game of tennis. The younger one, as a matter of fact, was ranked in the top hundred juniors in tennis in the United States. “He still wants to play competitive tennis, and at the same time do his masters. My older one is working in a software AI firm in the Bay Area,” says Venkata.

Venkata, however, is not in favour of any of his kids joining MosChip for full-time work. He is of the view that